

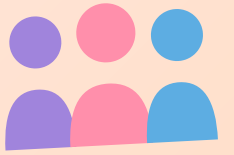
Finding Your Voice

Speaking with Confidence at Monmouth County

 Presented by Paul Ireifej — shouldcallpaul.com



It's About People, Not Words



Public speaking isn't a performance. It's a **conversation at scale**. The goal isn't to be impressive — it's to be **understood**.

See Them

Eye contact — not the back wall, not your slides. Actual humans.

Speak To Them

Use “you” and “we.” Pretend each row is a friend at coffee.

Care About Them

Audiences feel intent. If you care, they'll lean in.

Taming the Butterflies

← Back



Nerves are not your enemy — they're your body saying "this matters." Channel them.

1

Box Breathe

4 in · 4 hold · 4 out · 4 hold. Twice before you walk on.

2

Power Pose

Arms wide, chest open,
60 seconds backstage.
Real science.

3

First 30 Seconds

Memorize cold. Once you survive the opener, momentum carries you.

4

Reframe

Don't say "I'm nervous." Say "I'm **excited**." Same chemicals, better story.

The Power of Your Story

← Back



“ Facts tell. Stories **sell**. And stories are what we *remember*.

✗ Without a Story

“Our department processed 14,000 cases last year, a 12% increase.”

...forgotten by lunch.

✓ With a Story

“Mrs. Thompson called us in tears. Sixty seconds later we had her answer. We did that 14,000 times this year.”

...remembered for years.

Body Language Basics

← Back

Your audience reads your body before they hear your words. Make the message match.

Plant Your Feet

Hip-width apart. No swaying, no pacing. **Stillness = authority.**



Open Your Hands

Palms visible, gestures from the elbow. Closed fists feel defensive.

Soft Eyes, Real Smile

Lock eyes for 3 seconds at a time. Smile like you mean it — the room mirrors you.



 **GROUP EXERCISE**

The Human Commercial

Step 1. Turn to the person on your **right** (or left if you're at the end of a row). They're your partner.

Step 2. Each share **one fun fact** about yourself — *30 seconds each way*.

Step 3. I'll call on **3 brave volunteers** to stand and “commercial” their partner to the room — *30 seconds, make them sound amazing*.

 **5-Minute Activity** **Energy > Polish** **Use Their Name** **Make Them Look Good**

Visuals That Work

← Back



The slide is the *backup singer*. **You** are the lead.

✗ Avoid

- Walls of text
- Reading your slides aloud
- 8-color charts no one can decode
- Tiny fonts — row 12 can't see them

✓ Embrace

- One big idea per slide
- A single bold image or stat
- Bullets $\leq$ 6 words
- White space — let it breathe

Reading a Room

← Back

A big audience isn't one giant face — it's clusters of small ones.

1

Zone the Room

Mentally split into left / center / right. Speak to each zone every minute.

2

Ask & Pause

“Show of hands — who’s seen this before?” Pulls attention back instantly.

3

Watch the Phones

If 3+ phones come up, **change something** — pace, volume, or topic.



Leadership Through Communication

← Back



Every promotion in the County eventually depends on one thing: can you stand up and **move people**?

Champions Get Heard

Strong speakers get assigned to the projects that matter.



Trust Is Built Out Loud

Citizens trust the voice they recognize. Show up, speak up, repeat.

Voice = Career Velocity

The clearest communicators rise fastest — in every county, every department.

Thank You, Monmouth County!

← Back



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? Questions?



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